
Paper 2, Option 2B.2: The Dutch Revolt, c1563–1609

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of the successful challenge that the northern provinces of the Netherlands mounted against the power of the Spanish Empire in the years c1563–1609, a challenge that would contribute to a dramatic decline in Spain's power and produce one of the first republics of the era.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the challenges that the Dutch provinces overcame in securing their independence, the role of significant individuals, and the importance of religious differences between the northern and southern provinces in influencing the process of change.

Key topics	Content
1 Origins of the Dutch Revolt, c1563–67	• The Habsburg Netherlands: the 17 provinces; the extent of local autonomy; the traditional rights of the Dutch grandees. • The situation c1563: Philip II's policy towards the Netherlands and the lack of regard for established traditions; the regency of Margaret of Parma; the influence of Granvelle. • Opposition of the Dutch grandees: the alliance of Orange, Hoorn and Egmont; resistance to the reform of the bishoprics; the removal of Granvelle; Margaret and the heresy laws; the Confederacy of Noblemen; the Compromise of 1566; the 'Beggars'. • The impact of Calvinism: the Huguenot migration from France; hedge preaching; the revolt (Iconoclastic Fury) of 1566; the restoration of order; the effects of Calvinism on the Netherlands.
2 Alva and Orange, 1567–73	• Alva's rule: the replacement of Margaret of Parma; the execution of Egmont and Hoorn; the Council of Troubles and the attacks on heresy; reasons for the introduction of the Tenth Penny tax; growing opposition to the tax. • Orange's failure: his power and influence in the northern provinces; the invasions of 1568; the rebels' victory at Heiligerlee; disintegration of rebel forces and Alva's triumph. • The role of the Sea Beggars: Louis of Nassau and the privateers; the closing of English ports to the Sea Beggars by Elizabeth I of England 1572; the seizure of Brill and Flushing; development of a general revolt in the province of Holland.

Key topics	Content
3 Spain and the reconquest, 1573–84	• The failure of Requesens, 1573–76: his inability to defeat the northern provinces or to pay his troops; mutinies within the Spanish forces; the Spanish Fury of 1576; the Pacification of Ghent 1576; the advance of Calvinism in the southern provinces. • Reasons for the success of Parma, 1577–84: re-establishing Spanish rule in the south; the Union of Arras 1579 and its religious and political significance; Parma's diplomacy, military tactics and strategy; the fall of Antwerp 1584. • Foreign intervention in the Netherlands: Orange's decision to seek foreign help; the invitation to the Duke of Anjou 1578; the Duke's unpopularity and his withdrawal in 1583. • The growing independence of the northern provinces: the Union of Utrecht 1579; the Act of Abjuration 1581 and the establishing of the Republic of the United Provinces; the declining influence of Orange; his assassination in 1584.
4 Securing the independence of the United Provinces, 1584–1609	• Maurice of Nassau: his military reforms and changes in strategy and tactics; siege warfare against fortresses and border towns; the victories at Turnhout 1597 and Nieuwpoort 1600; Maurice as Stadtholder. • Reasons for Spanish failures: support for the United Provinces by Elizabeth I of England; the Treaty of Nonsuch 1585; the diversion of Parma's troops to support the Spanish Armada 1588; intervention in France 1589. • The growing power of the United Provinces: Oldenbarnevelt's reforms; the Dutch East India Company and the development of overseas trade; the growing divergence of north and south; Oldenbarnevelt's success in curbing Calvinist excesses. • The declining power of Spain in the Netherlands: Spain's inability to pay its troops; the armistice of 1607; the Truce of Antwerp 1609; Spain's <i>de facto</i> recognition of the independence of the United Provinces.

Route C: Revolutions in early modern and modern Europe

Overview

Students taking Route C will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1C: Britain, 1625–1701: conflict, revolution and settlement*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2C.1: France in revolution, 1774–99*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2C.2: Russia in revolution, 1894–1924.*

The options in Route C are linked by the theme of revolutions that span the early modern and modern periods. While the revolutionary upheavals in each country involved the overthrow of existing monarchies, the causes and the consequences of these revolutions differed in important ways. Students will study the causes and course of their chosen revolutions, and the outcome for the people of Britain and either France or Russia.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater appreciation of the nature of revolutions and the similarities and contrasts between them (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).